PROJECT BUDDY
Built by a tradesman, for tradesmen.

Garage Project Starter Checklist

Before you dig, pour or order

FIRST — PERMITS AND CHECKS

- [ ] **Building permit checked.** Many garages need one — ask your local building office before you start, not after.
- [ ] **Underground locates done.** Call your local locate service before any digging. It is free, and the lines do not care how careful you are.
- [ ] **Setbacks and lot coverage checked** against your local rules, on paper, before the layout goes down.
- [ ] **Slab spec decided.** Thickness, gravel base, and wire mesh or rebar — sized for what will park on it.

TOOLS — YOU NEED THIS

- [ ] Tape measure, string line and stakes
- [ ] 4 ft level
- [ ] Circular saw
- [ ] Drill / driver
- [ ] Hammer, pry bar and basic hand tools
- [ ] Wheelbarrow, shovel and rake
- [ ] Screed board and a concrete float, if you are pouring the slab

TOOLS — THIS MAKES IT EASIER

- [ ] **Laser level** — layout and heights, faster and straighter.
- [ ] **Framing nailer** — a long day of hand nailing, shortened.
- [ ] **Plate compactor** — rent it for the gravel base. A day's rental beats buying one.

MATERIALS, IN SHORT

Concrete and gravel for the slab; lumber for the framing; sheathing for the walls and roof; roofing; an overhead door and a man door; fasteners, hangers and hardware. The full list depends on your size and design.

FIRST STEPS

1. Lay out the footprint and check it against your setbacks.
2. Strip the topsoil, bring in the gravel base, and compact it.
3. Form the slab, set the mesh or rebar, and book the concrete.
4. Frame the walls and roof once the slab has cured.
5. Sheath, roof and doors — then lock-up.

Want the full package?

Complete drawings and a full material list for this project — plus every tool the job needs, marked where you need it — are in the **Plan Packages** on our website.

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Deck Project Starter Checklist

Before you dig, pour or order

FIRST — PERMITS AND CHECKS

- [ ] **Building permit checked.** Most decks need one — especially attached decks and anything up off the ground.
- [ ] **Underground locates done** before you dig a single post hole.
- [ ] **Ledger and railing rules checked** — how the deck fastens to the house, and when a railing is required.
- [ ] **Footing depth decided.** Footings go below your local frost line, every one of them.

TOOLS — YOU NEED THIS

- [ ] Tape measure, string line and stakes
- [ ] 4 ft level
- [ ] Drill / driver
- [ ] Circular saw
- [ ] Post-hole digger or a spade
- [ ] Wheelbarrow and shovel, for the footing concrete
- [ ] Ladder

TOOLS — THIS MAKES IT EASIER

- [ ] **Post-hole auger — rent it.** For one deck it beats buying, and it sure beats a weekend of hand digging.
- [ ] **Mitre saw** — clean, square cuts on decking and railing.
- [ ] **Laser level** — footings level across the whole footprint.

MATERIALS, IN SHORT

Posts, beams and joists; decking boards; concrete for the footings; hangers, bolts and hardware; railing where it is required; screws rated for treated lumber. The full list depends on your size and design.

FIRST STEPS

1. Lay out the deck and mark every post hole.
2. Dig the footings below the frost line and pour the concrete.
3. Set the posts, then the beams, then the joists — level as you go.
4. Fasten the ledger to the house with proper bolts and flashing.
5. Decking down, then the stairs and railing.

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